Chen Cecilia Liu

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Research Interests

Multilinguality, Generalization, Multicultural NLP, Pragmatics-related tasks, Multimodality

Education

TU Darmstadt Darmstadt, Germany
ELLIS PhD in Computer Sciences 2021 - Present
Supervisors: Prof. Iryna Gurevych (Darmstadt) / Prof. Anna Korhonen (Cambridge)

University of Cambridge Cambridge, United Kingdom
Visiting Student 2024
Supervisor: Prof. Anna Korhonen

University of Toronto Toronto, Canada
Master of Applied Science, Electrical Engineering 2011 - 2013
Supervisor: Prof. Brendan Frey

Bachelor of Applied Science (with Honours), Mechanical Engineering 2006 - 2010

Selected Publications

10. **Chen Liu**, Iryna Gurevych and Anna Korhonen. Culturally Aware and Culturally Adapted NLP: A Taxonomy and Survey. *Preprint - under review*, 2024.
9. **Chen Liu** and Iryna Gurevych. Early Period of Training Impacts Out-of-Distribution Generalization. *Preprint - under review*, 2024. (A workshop version is accepted at HiLD@ICML 2024 and CoLLAs 2024)
8. **Chen Liu**, Fajri Koto, Timothy Baldwin, and Iryna Gurevych. Are Multilingual LLMs Culturally-Diverse Reasoners? An Investigation into Multicultural Proverbs and Sayings. NAACL-HLT, 2024.
7. **Chen Liu**, Jonas Pfeiffer, Ivan Vulić, and Iryna Gurevych. Improving Generalization of Adapter-Based Cross-lingual Transfer with Scheduled Unfreezing. NAACL-HLT, 2024.
6. **Chen Liu**, Jonas Pfeiffer, Anna Korhonen, Ivan Vulić, and Iryna Gurevych. Delving Deeper into Cross-lingual Visual Question Answering. EACL - *Findings*, 2023.
5. Gregor Geigle, **Chen Liu**, Jonas Pfeiffer, and Iryna Gurevych. One does not fit all! On the Complementarity of Vision Encoders for Vision and Language Tasks. RepL4NLP@ACL, 2023.
4. **Chen Liu***, Gregor Geigle*, Robin Krebs, and Iryna Gurevych. FigMemes: A Dataset for Figurative Language Identification in Politically-Opinionated Memes. EMNLP, 2022.
3. Amir Ganiev, Colton Chapin, Anderson De Andrade, and **Chen Liu**. An Architecture for Accelerated Large-Scale Inference of Transformer-Based Language Models. NAACL - *Industry Track*, 2021.
2. **Chen Liu**, Anderson De Andrade, and Muhammad Osama. 2019. Exploring Multilingual Syntactic Sentence Representations. W-NUT@EMNLP, 2019.
1. **Chen Liu**, Muhammad Osama, and Anderson De Andrade. DENS: A Dataset for Multi-class Emotion Analysis. EMNLP, 2019.

Honours, Scholarships & Grants

ELIZA Scholarship, DAAD	2024
Travel Grant, ELLIS	2022
Undergraduate Student Research Awards (USRA), NSERC	2008, 2009
Dean's List, University of Toronto	2007 - 2010
General Motor of Women in Electrical and Mechanical Engineering Award, University of Toronto	2007 - 2009
Mechanical and Industrial Engineering Admission Scholarship, University of Toronto	2006
Faculty of Applied Sciences and Engineering Admission Scholarship, University of Toronto	2006

Services

Reviewer/Program committee:

EMNLP (2020, 2022), ACL (2020, 2023), EACL (2021), NAACL (2021), ACL Rolling Review (2022-)
NeurIPs (2023, 2024), ICLR (2024, 2025), ICML (2024), COLM (2024), AAAI (2024)
RepL4NLP@ACL (2024), WiNLP@EMNLP (2024)

Women in Data Conference, Industry Mentor, Toronto	2019
Google Go North Conference, Industry Mentor, Toronto	2017
ECE Department Annual Graduate Students Conference, Organizer, University of Toronto	2012
Graduate Student Union Student Representative, University of Toronto	2012 - 2013

Talks

Ontario Tech University, and University of Toronto, Invited Talk (Culturally Aware and Adapted NLP)	2024
DATEXIS Lab@Berliner Hochschule für Technik, Invited Talk (PEFT & Cross-lingual Transfer),	2024
CHIA Annual Conference on AI for Good, Poster Presentation, University of Cambridge	2024
Women in Data Science Conference, Invited Talk, Toronto	2019
Vector Institute Endless Summer School, Invited Talk, University of Toronto	2018

Teaching Experience

Electrical Fundamentals, Tutorial, University of Toronto	2011
Fundamentals of Computer Programming, Lab, University of Toronto	2010
Grade 12 Physics / Chemistry, William International College	2007

Mentorship

Nils Kovacic (with Hiba Arnaout), TU Darmstadt	BSc Thesis, Culturally-aware NLP, Emotion
Kai Li, TU Darmstadt	BSc Thesis, Culturally-aware NLP, Multimodality
Jonas Stadtmüller, TU Darmstadt	MSc Thesis, Continual Learning, Multimodality
Laurenz Kammeyer, TU Darmstadt	BSc Thesis, Prompting
Amir Ganiev, University of Toronto	BASc PEY
Amanda Steinhauer, University of Toronto	BASc PEY

Relevant Industry Experience

Wattpad, (acquired by NAVER) Toronto, Canada
Staff Product & Research Data Scientist Oct 2020 - Dec 2020

Senior Product & Research Data Scientist, Tech Lead May 2017 - Oct 2020
Spotify Boston, USA
Machine Learning Engineer Sep 2016 - May 2017
Meta, (acquired by Chan Zuckerberg Initiative) Toronto, Canada
Machine Learning Engineer Mar 2014 - Aug 2016